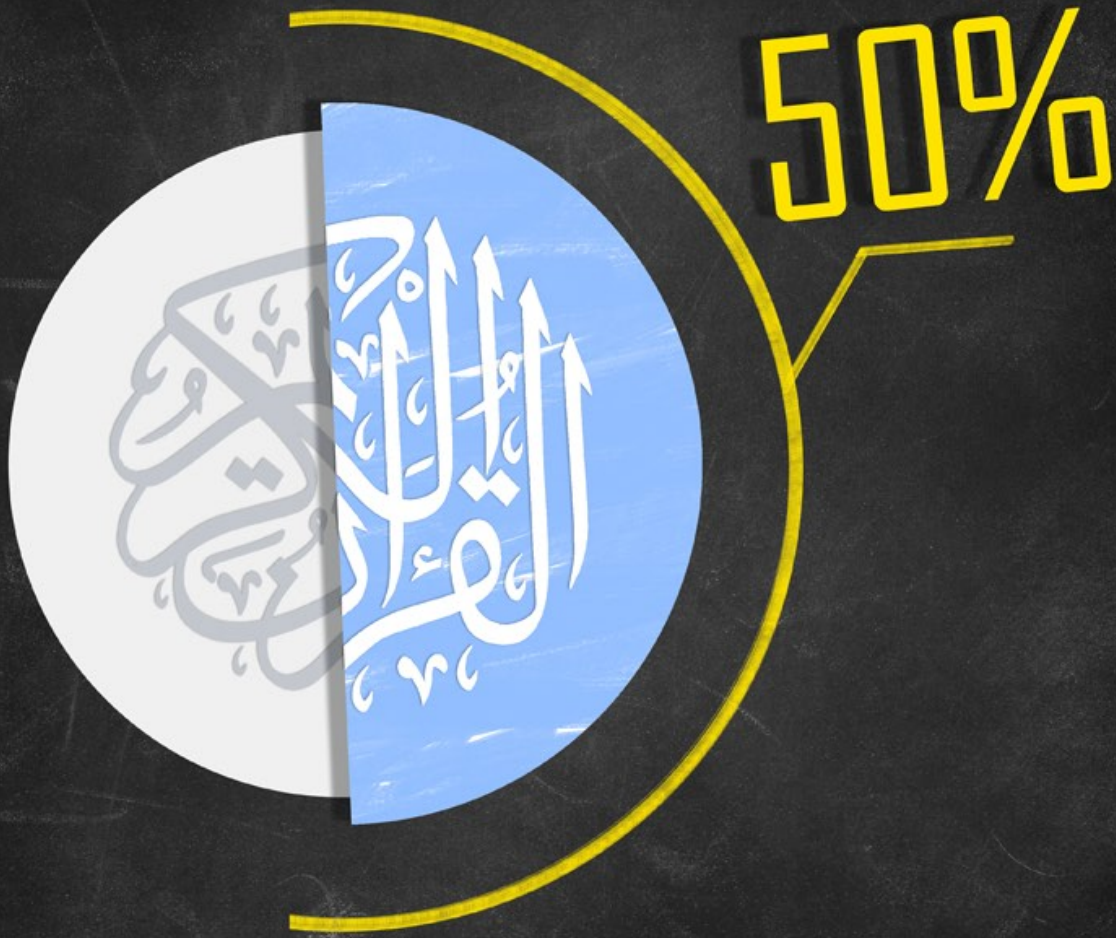




How to UNDERSTAND



THE OF QURAN

A complete Guide for non-Arabs to read & Understand the Quran in Arabic



How to
UNDERSTAND
the Quran in Arabic

THE

How to Understand the Quran

A complete self-study guide for non-Arabs to understand
as much as 50% of the Noble Quran in Arabic

Islam Fekry



A r a b i c 1 0 1 . o r g

How to UNDERSTAND the Quran

By: Drs. Islam Fekry

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Learn & Leave a Legacy

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Acknowledgements

(وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ تَوَكَّلْتُ وَإِلَيْهِ أُنِيبُ)

My success is from God alone. In Him I have placed my trust, and to Him I turn. (Hud, 88)

First of all, Alhamdulillah .. Alhamdulillah that I am in a position to help others learn the true word of Allah, so Alhamdulillah, and may Allah accept my humble work. Amen.

Second, to my wife who has always stood by me, and bore more than anyone can. Thank you!

To my family and friends who supported me all the way.
Thank you!

To everyone who supported me on YouTube through my channel, Thank You, and Jazakum Allahu khairan for the incredible support.

Introduction

The Noble Quran is the most perfect book there is, and no wonder – it is the word of Allah. The Quran was revealed in the language of prophet Muhammed (peace and blessings be upon him) – Arabic, and it is preserved to this day letter-for-letter and word-for-word. Since the Noble Quran is only and exclusively in Arabic, all Muslims around the world, no matter what their background is, must have a degree of knowledge about the Arabic language. As a teacher, it is my duty to use the knowledge that was gifted to me, in order to help other brothers and sisters of non-Arab roots around the world to learn and study the true word of Allah.

Allah says in the Noble Quran:

كِتَابٌ أَنْزَلْنَاهُ إِلَيْكَ مُبَارَكٌ لِيَدَّبَّرُوا آيَاتِهِ وَلِيَتَذَكَّرَ أُولُوا الْأَلْبَابِ ﴿٢٩﴾

A blessed Book that We sent down to you, that they may ponder its Verses, and for those with intelligence to take heed.

(Saad, 29)

And since the main purpose of the revelations of the Noble Quran is to ponder over the word of Allah and to try and apply these revelations on our lives, understanding the Noble Quran is, therefore, indispensable to fulfill the main purpose for which Allah revealed the Quran. This means that learning Arabic to some degree is essential to fully grasp the beauty and accuracy of Allah's words. However, the classical method of learning Arabic, regardless of its effectivity or the lack thereof, has proven to be a long and time-consuming method, and requires a lot of time. A privilege that many of us, unfortunately, do not have much of. It has become increasingly evident that many learners who start learning classical Arabic, or MSA, with the purpose of learning the Quran, find it difficult to finish the course which could take several months before starting to notice any real progress. As a result, there had to be a method that can offer a solution to this problem: learning and understanding the Quran, without having to spend months and maybe even years to see some results. That is why, a new

term was coined ‘Quranic Arabic’ which refers to all the necessary skills needed to read and understand the Quran without having to dive deeply into Arabic Grammar, and vocabulary that will never be used in your area of interest.

And this is exactly where this book comes in. This humble work, which is based on the work of Dr. Abdul Azeez Abdul Rahmaan, tries to list the most frequently used vocabulary in the Noble Quran in order to learn this by heart, as a first serious step towards reading and understanding the sacred text. And through a second step, some bits of basic Arabic grammar knowledge, a learner could find himself reading and understanding the Noble Quran in its original form in Arabic in less than 6 months.

This book, like any branch of knowledge related to the Quran, is best utilized under the supervision of a certified Quran teacher. However, this book was designed in a way that can also suit the self-learner, to learn and make progress if you do not have the privilege to learn under a teacher in your local mosque. Bear in mind, you can always contact me, the author, to ask questions and for your feedback as well.

May Allah accept my humble work, and make my intentions purely for His sake. Amen.

The Method used in this book

The following chart refers to the method which I devised to make it easy for non-Arabs to learn the Quran from absolute scratch to reading and understanding the Quran. Each step is built on the foundations of the previous step. It is, therefore, imperative that before you start learning a certain step, that you have grasped all the steps under it.



This book (How to understand 50% of the Quran) is first of a series of books which constitute the fifth step in the method I devised to reach your goal (see chart). This means that you, who are about to start learning how to understand the Quran, are able to recite the Quran with acceptable tajweed. And this means that you have some knowledge about the special Arabic sounds. And doubtlessly, you have good knowledge of Arabic Alphabet system, as well as its vowel system.

If that is not the case, or you want to be sure of your knowledge before embarking on this journey. *No worries!*

For each of these steps (step 1 up to 4) There are online courses which I have put together, and which you can find on my website: Arabic101.org And if you want to get a quick access to these courses, you can find the links here below:

Step ONE: <https://arabic101.org/courses/how-to-read-arabic-basics/>

Step TWO: <https://arabic101.org/courses/arabic-vowels-system/>

Step THREE: <https://arabic101.org/courses/arabic-pronunciation-course/>

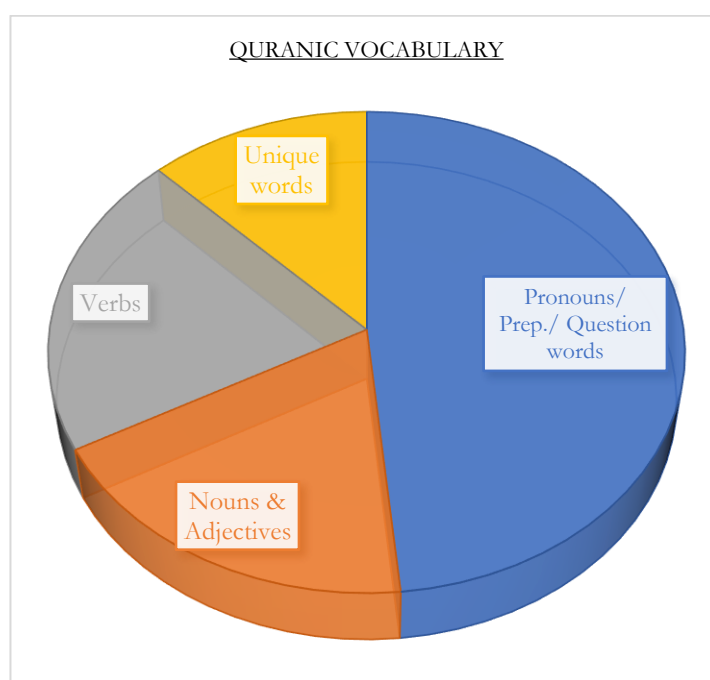
Step FOUR: <https://arabic101.org/courses/tajweed-of-the-quran-from-a-z/>

Step FIVE: <https://arabic101.org/courses/understand-the-Noble-quran/>

All courses are FREE of charge, and all you need to do, is sign up and start learning.

How does this book work?

The Noble Quran consists of 114 surahs, and 6236 ayas. If you count every single word from cover to cover, you will find out that they are about 18,994 unique words in total. Importantly, you do not need to learn all of them to get grasp of the Quran because of the number of repeated words. As a matter of fact, roughly 50% of the entire Noble Quran is made up using only 77 words! Yes. You read that correctly. This book will concern itself with this list of words. Nearly every single word on this list is repeated hundreds if not thousands of times in the Quran, and in many different forms. Once you get to know the meaning of the root word, things get a whole lot easier. See Chart:



This books only deals with the BLUE part of the pie chart, the greater part of the vocabulary of the Noble Quran which is around 50%. And by the end of this book, you will immediately see the difference yourself, and you will notice how things are starting to make sense.

Why is this book different from others, other books/ lists?

This is not the first attempt to gather the most frequently used words in the Quran. However, this book is the first to use the Uthmani script to teach the word lists, so the words you see in each list, is written in the same way as you would see it in your mus'haf¹. This makes it much easier to recognize the words and learn faster.

How should you use this book?

The first and best option is learning with book under the supervision of a certified teacher who can give guidance and show you the proper way of pronunciation and correct your mistakes. However, for those who do not have access to a Quran teacher, you should keep in mind the following points:

- It is not recommended to learn a lot of words (more than one list) within a single week. You should give yourself the chance to study the words carefully, as well as their examples. It is very important to read lots of Quran, and try and find these learned words as you read, and keep asking yourself 'what does this word mean?'
- This book offers you along with the lists in Uthmani script, context examples to train your eyes on how the words look when they are used and/or combined with other parts of words. It is highly recommended that you study these examples as you go through the lists. You will start picking up words faster, and you will also see words that you have already learned, which makes the learning process much more effective.
- You can also make use of the Memrise page of Arabic101, which helps you learn the words much faster and much more effectively. Memrise is a FREE app (and also a website) which you can use to learn word lists. I have also added the audio pronunciation of the words you are supposed to learn to make it easier for those who cannot reach a Quran teacher. Here on the right you can find a QR Code with the link for the Memrise page.



Finally, remember to purify your intentions before starting this journey so that, *in shaa Allah*, you will be rewarded for every step of the way, and ask Allah for forgiveness and guidance since He alone is able to make things, no matter how difficult they are much easier.

Bismillah ...

¹ The word Mus'haf مُصْحَف is an Arabic word which refers to the physical copy of the Quran. The Quran, however, is the spoken words, not the book itself.

List ONE

Demonstrative Pronouns²

This legend will give more information about the gender/ number of the pronouns in question.



Male



Female



Plural

² [In English] Demonstrative pronouns are words, such as 'this' and 'that', used to indicate what you are referring to.
This book. *That* pen. *Those* people ..etc.

English	Details	Arabic
This		هَذَا
That		ذَلِكَ
This		هَذِهِ
That		تِلْكَ
These		هَؤُلَاءِ
Those		أُولَئِكَ
He who		الَّذِي
She who		الَّتِي
Those who		الَّذِينَ
These		هَذِهِ
Those		تِلْكَ
Those who		الَّتِي

List 1-7 – Discussion

This



هَذَا

قَالُوا هَذَا الَّذِي رَزَقْنَا مِنْ قَبْلُ^ط

They will say, “**This** is what we were provided with before,”

مَاذَا أَرَادَ اللَّهُ بِهَذَا مَثَلًا

“What did God intend by **this** example?”

فَهَذَا يَوْمُ الْبَعْثِ

This is the Day of Resurrection

That



ذَلِكَ

Though the word ذاك (and similar demonstrative pronouns for that matter) means ‘that’ and is therefore used to refer to far objects, it can sometimes be used with closer objects that are high in value, place or position. This is because of the connotation of such Arabic words. It should not come as a surprise that sometimes the word ذاك will be translated into ‘this’ rather than ‘that’ because English demonstrative pronouns do not have the same connotations. The following example highlights this phenomenon.

ذَلِكَ الْكِتَابُ لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ

This (that) is the Book in which there is no doubt

وَمَا لَهُمْ بِذَلِكَ مِنْ عِلْمٍ إِنْ هُمْ إِلَّا يَظُنُّونَ

Of **that** they have no knowledge; they merely conjecture.

فَذَلِكَ يَوْمَئِذٍ يَوْمٌ عَسِيرٌ

That Day will be a difficult day.

This



هَذِهِ

وَلَا تَقْرَبَا هَذِهِ الشَّجَرَةَ

but do not approach **this** tree

لِّلَّذِينَ أَحْسَنُوا فِي هَذِهِ الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةٌ

For those who do good in **this** world, is goodness.

قَالَ هَذِهِ نَاقَةٌ لَهَا شِرْبٌ

“**This** is a she-camel; she has her turn of drinking,

That



تِلْكَ

تِلْكَ أُمَّةٌ قَدْ خَلَتْ

That was a community that has passed;

وَتِلْكَ حُجَّتُنَا ءَاتَيْنَاهَا إِبْرَاهِيمَ عَلَى قَوْمِهِ

That was Our argument which We gave to Abraham against his people.

These



هَؤُلَاءِ

وَجِئْنَا بِكَ عَلَى هَؤُلَاءِ شَهِيدًا

and We bring you as a witness against **these**?

لَيَقُولُوا أَهَؤُلَاءِ مَنَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِم

“Are **these** the ones whom God has favored from among us?”

Those



أُولَئِكَ

أُولَئِكَ عَلَى هُدًى مِّن رَّبِّهِمْ

Those are upon guidance from their Lord. These are the successful.

فَأُولَئِكَ أَتُوبُ عَلَيْهِمْ وَأَنَا التَّوَّابُ الرَّحِيمُ

Those—I will accept their repentance. I am the Acceptor of Repentance, the Merciful.

He who



الَّذِي

مَثَلُهُمْ كَمَثَلِ الَّذِي أَشْتَوْقَدَ نَارًا

Their likeness is that of a **person who** kindled a fire;

أَوْ كَالَّذِي مَرَّ عَلَى قَرْيَةٍ

Or like **him who** passed by a town

ءَامِنُوا بِالَّذِي أُنْزِلَ عَلَى الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا

Believe in **that which** was revealed to the believers

She who



الَّتِي

وَاتَّقُوا النَّارَ الَّتِي أُعِدَّتْ لِلْكَافِرِينَ ﴿١٣٦﴾

And guard yourselves against the Fire **that is** prepared for the disbelievers.

أَدْفَعْ بِالَّتِي هِيَ أَحْسَنُ السَّيِّئَةِ نَحْنُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا يَصِفُونَ

Repel evil by **what is** better. We are aware of what they describe.

وَلَا تَكُونُوا كَالَّتِي نَقَضَتْ غَزْلَهَا

And do not be like **her who** unravels her yarn,

Those who(m)



الَّذِينَ

صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ

The path of **those whom** You have blessed,

وَلَا تَكُونُوا كَالَّذِينَ تَفَرَّقُوا

And do not be like **those who** separated

فَحَاقَ بِالَّذِينَ سَخِرُوا مِنْهُمْ

but **those who** mocked them became besieged by what they ridiculed.

Those



تِلْكَ

تِلْكَ أَمَانِيُّهُمْ

Those are their wishes.

تِلْكَ حُدُودُ اللَّهِ

Those are the bounds set by God.

List TWO

Negations/ Exceptions

This legend will be used in this list to give more information about the gender of some modifiers.



Male



Female

English	Arabic
Yes	نَعَمْ
Yes, indeed	بَلَى
Certainly not	كَلَّا
Except	إِلَّا
Nothing but	إِنْ .. إِلَّا
Nothing but	مَا .. إِلَّا
So as not to/ that not	أَلَّا
Do(es) <u>not</u>	لَا
<u>Not</u> (continuous)	مَا
Will <u>not</u>	لَنْ
Did <u>not</u>	لَمْ
(There is) no	 لَيْسَتْ  لَيْسَ
Other than/ not	غَيْرَ
Apart from	مِنْ دُونِ

List 2-7 – Discussion

Notice that some Arabic words/ expressions can deliver a certain meaning with different degrees of intensity depending on the context of an aya. That is why you will see that some words will not be translated in the same way all the time, since context plays a role when being translated in English. However, as a beginner, learning a single meaning/ variation is more than enough to understand the message conveyed in a certain aya.

Yes

نَعَمْ

فَهَلْ وَجَدْتُمْ مَا وَعَدَ رَبُّكُمْ حَقًّا قَالُوا نَعَمْ

Did you find what your Lord promised you to be true?" They will say, "Yes."

قَالَ نَعَمْ وَإِنَّكُمْ لَمِنَ الْمُقَرَّبِينَ

He said, "Yes, and you will be among my favorites."

Yes, indeed

بَلَىٰ

بَلَىٰ مَنْ كَسَبَ سَيِّئَةً وَأَحَاطَتْ بِهِ خَطِيئَتُهُ

Yes Indeed, whoever commits misdeeds, and becomes besieged by his iniquities—

بَلَىٰ مَنْ أَسْلَمَ وَجْهَهُ لِلَّهِ وَهُوَ مُحْسِنٌ

Indeed, whoever submits himself to God, and is a doer of good,

Certainly not

كَلَّا

كَلَّا سَنَكْتُبُ مَا يَقُولُ

No indeed! We will write what he says,

كَلَّا إِنَّهَا كَلِمَةٌ هُوَ قَائِلُهَا

Certainly not! It is just a word that he utters.

Except

إِلَّا

اللَّهُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ الْحَيُّ الْقَيُّومُ

God! There is no god **except** He, the Living, the Everlasting.

مَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يَشْفَعُ عِنْدَهُ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِهِ

Who is he that can intercede with Him **except** with His permission?

Nothing but

إِنْ .. إِلَّا

ثُمَّ جَاءُوكَ يَخْلِفُونَ بِاللَّهِ إِنْ أَرَدْنَا إِلَّا إِحْسَانًا وَتَوْفِيقًا

“We **only** intended goodwill and reconciliation”?

إِنْ هَذَا إِلَّا سِحْرٌ مُبِينٌ

“This is **nothing but** plain magic.”

Nothing but

مَا .. إِلَّا

مَا قُلْتُ لَهُمْ إِلَّا مَا أَمَرْتَنِي بِهِ

“This is **nothing but** plain magic.”

فَقَالَ الْمَلَأُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا مِنْ قَوْمِهِ مَا هَذَا إِلَّا بَشَرٌ مِثْلُكُمْ

But the notables of his people, who disbelieved, said, “This is **nothing but** a human like you,

إِنَّ الْحُكْمَ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ أَمَرَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ

He has commanded **that** you worship **none** but Him.

وَمَا لَنَا أَلَّا نَتَوَكَّلَ عَلَى اللَّهِ

“And why should we **not** trust in God,

The word لا is used to convey negation in Arabic, but only when it comes to present verbs. It is important to know that in English has many different ways to convey negations in the present tenses (not only do not/ does not), which could be seen in the following examples:

لَا يُسْمِنُ وَلَا يُغْنِي مِنْ جُوعٍ

That **neither** nourishes, **nor** satisfies hunger.

لَا تَسْمَعُ فِيهَا لَغِيَةً ﴿١١﴾

In it you will hear **no** nonsense.

The Arabic word ما is possibly one of the most flexible words in Arabic, which could be used with different meanings. There is an entire chapter later in this book which will be dedicated to this word only. One of the reasons why we consider it to be flexible is that we use it to negate verbs in present and also past, unlike لا which is only used with present verbs.

يُخَدِّعُونَ اللَّهَ وَالَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَمَا يُخَدِّعُونَ إِلَّا أَنْفُسَهُمْ

They seek to deceive God and those who believe, but they deceive **none** but themselves,

وَمَا كَفَرَ سُلَيْمَنُ وَلَكِنَّ الشَّيَاطِينَ كَفَرُوا

Solomon disbelieved **not**, but the Satans disbelieved,

Will not

لَنْ

قَالَ لَنْ أُرْسِلَهُ مَعَكُمْ حَتَّى تُؤْتُونِ

He said, "I **will not** send him with you, unless you give me a pledge before God

فَلَنْ أَبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ حَتَّى يَأْذَنَ لِي أَبِي

I **will not** leave this land until my father permits me,

Did not

لَمْ

The major use of the Arabic word لم is past negation. This of course includes different types past tenses in English; so not just 'did not'. It could also be used as 'have not', 'had not' and 'would not'. In other words, as long as it has to do with the past tense, it can be used.

وَيُعَلِّمُكُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحِكْمَةَ وَيُعَلِّمُكُم مَّا لَمْ تَكُونُوا تَعْلَمُونَ

and teach you the Book and the wisdom, and what you **did not** know;

وَنَحْنُ أَحَقُّ بِالْمُلْكِ مِنْهُ وَلَمْ يُؤْتَ سَعَةً مِّنَ الْمَالِ

when we are more worthy of authority than he, and he **was not** given plenty of wealth?"

(There is) no



لَيْسَتْ



لَيْسَ

لَيْسَ لَهُمْ طَعَامٌ إِلَّا مِن ضَرِيعٍ ﴿٦﴾

They will have **no** food except thorns.

لَيْسَ عَلَيْكُمْ جُنَاحٌ أَنْ تَدْخُلُوا بُيُوتًا غَيْرَ مَسْكُونَةٍ

There is **no** blame on you for entering uninhabited houses,

وَقَالَتِ الْيَهُودُ لَيْسَتْ النَّصْرَى عَلَى شَيْءٍ

The Jews say, "The Christians are **not** based on anything;"

Other than/ not

غَيْرُ

مَنْ إِلَهُ غَيْرُ اللَّهِ يَأْتِيكُمْ بِضِيَاءٍ

Which god **other than** God will bring you illumination? Do you not hear?"

صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا الضَّالِّينَ ﴿٧﴾

The path of those You have blessed, **not** of those against whom there is anger, nor of those who are misguided.

Apart from

مِنْ دُونِ

وَمَا لَكُمْ مِّنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ مِنْ وَلِيٍّ وَلَا نَصِيرٍ

and that **apart from** God you have no guardian or helper?

وَقَالَ إِنَّمَا اتَّخَذْتُمْ مِّنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ أَوْثَنًا

And he said, 'You have only taken to yourselves idols, **apart from** God,

List THREE

Question words

English	Arabic
Yes/ no Questions	أَ / هَلْ
What ...?	مَا / مَاذَا
Why...?	لِمَ
Who...?	مَنْ
When ...?	مَتَى
Where...?	أَيْنَ
How...?	كَيْفَ
How many/ much?	كَمْ
Which?	أَيُّ
How...? (mostly rhetorical)	أَنَّى

List 3-7 – Discussion

Yes/ no Questions

أ / هَلْ

The hamza (أ) is a prefix that can be added to the beginning of Arabic words to form a yes-no question. The subject of that sentence is then determined by the word to which أ is attached. The hamza (أ) can also appear as only (ء) at the beginning of words that already start with a hamza (أ). The word هل, on the other hand, is a stand-alone word which gives the same meaning and has the same function. The translation of both of these words to English depends on the tense of the sentence. Therefore, you will see it translated at 'is this ..', 'Do they ..', 'will they ..' and so on.

أَهَؤُلَاءِ الَّذِينَ أَقْسَمُوا بِاللَّهِ جَهْدَ أَيْمَانِهِمْ إِنَّهُمْ لَمَعَكُمْ

Are these the ones who swore by God most earnest oaths that they were with you?

أَهَذَا الَّذِي يَذْكُرُ ءَالِهَتَكُمْ

“**Is** this the one who mentions your gods?”

ءَأَرْبَابٌ مُتَفَرِّقُونَ خَيْرٌ أَمْ اللَّهُ الْوَاحِدُ الْقَهَّارُ ﴿٣٩﴾

Are diverse lords better, or God, the One, the Supreme?”

يَقُولُونَ هَلْ لَنَا مِنَ الْأَمْرِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ ۚ

saying, “**Is** anything up to us?”

وَيُضِدَّكُمْ عَنْ ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ وَعَنِ الصَّلَاةِ ۚ فَهَلْ أَنْتُمْ مُنْتَهُونَ ﴿٩١﴾

and to prevent you from the remembrance of God, and from prayer. **Will** you not desist?

What ...?

مَا/ مَاذَا

يُرِيدُ أَنْ يُخْرِجَكُمْ مِنْ أَرْضِكُمْ بِسِحْرِهِ ۖ فَمَاذَا تَأْمُرُونَ

“He wants to evict you from your land, so **what** do you recommend?”

فَأَلْقَاهُ إِلَيْهِمْ ثُمَّ تَوَلَّى فَأَنْظُرْ مَاذَا يَرْجِعُونَ ﴿٢٨﴾

and deliver it to them; and withdraw, then see **what** reply they give in return.”

Why...?

لِمَ

قَالَ يَقُومُ لِمَ تَسْتَعْجِلُونَ بِالسَّيِّئَةِ قَبْلَ الْحَسَنَةِ ۖ

He said, “O my people, **why** are you quick to do evil rather than good?

وَقَالُوا لَجُلُودِهِمْ لِمَ شَهِدْتُمْ عَلَيْنَا ۖ

And they will say to their skins, “**Why** did you testify against us?”

Who / whoever

مَنْ

وَمَنْ أَحْسَنُ قَوْلًا مِمَّنْ دَعَا إِلَى اللَّهِ وَعَمِلَ صَالِحًا

And **who** is better in speech than someone **who** calls to God, and acts with integrity,

وَلَيْنَ سَأَلْتَهُمْ مَنْ خَلَقَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ

And if you ask them, “**Who** created the heavens and the earth?”

وَيَقُولُونَ مَتَى هَذَا الْوَعْدُ إِن كُنْتُمْ صَادِقِينَ

And they say, “**When** will this promise be fulfilled, if you are truthful?”

فَسَيَنْغِضُونَ إِلَيْكَ رُءُوسَهُمْ وَيَقُولُونَ مَتَى هُوَ

Then they will nod their heads at you, and say, “**When** will it be?”

It is important to mention that the word أين can be attached to ما forming أينما, but when this happens, the word أين will lose its ability to form questions, so be sure that it is not attached to anything else so that it would be understood as a question word. The word أينما will be discussed in the final chapter of this book along with other combinations that go with the word ما.

وَيَوْمَ يُنَادِيهِمْ فَيَقُولُ أَيْنَ شُرَكَائِيَ الَّذِينَ كُنْتُمْ تَزْعُمُونَ ﴿٦٢﴾

On the Day when He will call to them, and say, “**Where** are My associates whom you used to claim?”

وَقِيلَ لَهُمْ أَيْنَ مَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْبُدُونَ ﴿٩٢﴾

And it will be said to them, “**Where** are those you used to worship?”

أَوَلَمْ يَرَوْا كَيْفَ يُبْدِئُ اللَّهُ الْخُلُقَ ثُمَّ يُعِيدُهُ

Have they not seen **how** God originates the creation, and then reproduces it?

فَانْظُرُوا كَيْفَ بَدَأَ الْخُلُقَ

Say, “Roam the earth, and observe **how** He originated the creation.”

How many/ much?

كَمْ

In English, we differentiate between countable and uncountable nouns. This is not the case when it comes to Arabic; therefore, the word كَمْ will be used when asking about both countable and uncountable nouns.

أَلَمْ يَرَوْا كَمْ أَهْلَكْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِهِمْ مِنْ قَرْنٍ

Have they not considered **how many** generations We destroyed before them?

وَكَمْ قَصَمْنَا مِنْ قَرْيَةٍ كَانَتْ ظَالِمَةً

How many a guilty town have We crushed,

Which?

أَيُّ

قُلْ أَيُّ شَيْءٍ أَكْبَرُ شَهَادَةً

Say, “**What thing** is more solemn in testimony?”

فَأَيُّ الْفَرِيقَيْنِ أَحَقُّ بِالْأَمْنِ

Which side is more entitled to security, if you are aware?”

How...? (Mostly rhetorical³)

أَنَّى

ذَٰلِكُمُ اللَّهُ فَأَنَّى تُؤْفَكُونَ ﴿٩٥﴾

Such is God. So **how** could you deviate?

أَنَّى يَكُونُ لَهُ وَلَدٌ وَلَمْ تَكُنْ لَهُ صَاحِبَةً

how can He have a son when He never had a companion?

³ Rhetorical questions are asked just to make a point but not because you want an answer.

List FOUR

Prepositions (PART I)

English	Arabic
Above/ on/ over	فَوْقَ
Under(neath)/ beneath	تَحْتَ
Right (hand)	يَمِين
Left (hand)	شِمَال
Between/ Among	بَيْنَ
In front of	بَيْنَ أَيْدَى / بَيْنَ يَدَى
Behind / successor	خَلْفَ
Behind/ beyond (after)	وَرَاءَ
(A)round	حَوْلَ
Wherever	حَيْثُ
Wherever	أَيْنَمَا

List 4-7 – Discussion

Above/ on/ over

فَوْقَ

إِنِّي أَرْنَيْ أَحْمِلُ فَوْقَ رَأْسِي خُبْزًا تَأْكُلُ الطَّيْرُ مِنْهُ

"I dreamt that I was carrying bread **on** my head, and the birds were pecking at it.

وَجَاعِلُ الَّذِينَ اتَّبَعُوكَ فَوْقَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَمَةِ

and hold those who follow you **above** those who disbelieve till the Day of Resurrection.

وَرَفَعَ بَعْضَكُمْ فَوْقَ بَعْضٍ دَرَجَاتٍ لِّيَبْلُوكُمْ فِي مَا ءَاتَاكُمْ

and exalted some in rank **over** others in order to try you by what He has given you.

Under(neath)/ beneath

تَحْتَ

قُلْ هُوَ الْقَادِرُ عَلَى أَنْ يَبْعَثَ عَلَيْكُمْ عَذَابًا مِّنْ فَوْقِكُمْ أَوْ مِنْ تَحْتِ أَرْجُلِكُمْ

Say, "He is Able to send upon you an affliction, from above you, or from **under** your feet.

فَنَادَاهَا مِنْ تَحْتِهَا أَلَّا تَحْزَنِي قَدْ جَعَلَ رَبُّكِ تَحْتَكِ سَرِيًّا ﴿٢٤﴾

Whereupon he called her from **beneath** her: "Do not worry; your Lord has placed a stream beneath you.

لَقَدْ كَانَ لِسَبَإٍ فِي مَسْكَنِهِمْ ءَايَةٌ جَنَّتَانِ عَنْ يَمِينٍ وَشِمَالٍ

In Sheba's homeland there used to be a wonder: two gardens, on the **right**, and on the left.

قَالُوا إِنَّكُمْ كُنْتُمْ تَأْتُونَنَا عَنْ الْيَمِينِ ﴿٢٨﴾

They will say, "You used to come at us from the **right**."

وَمَا تِلْكَ بِيَمِينِكَ يَمْوَسَىٰ ﴿١٧﴾

And what is that in your **right-hand**, O Moses?"

لَقَدْ كَانَ لِسَبَإٍ فِي مَسْكَنِهِمْ ءَايَةٌ جَنَّتَانِ عَنْ يَمِينٍ وَشِمَالٍ

In Sheba's homeland there used to be a wonder: two gardens, on the right, and on the **left**.

إِذْ يَتَلَقَّى الْمُتَلَقِّيَانِ عَنِ الْيَمِينِ وَعَنِ الشِّمَالِ قَعِيدٌ ﴿١٧﴾

As the two receivers receive, seated to the right and to the **left**.

وَأَصْحَابُ الشِّمَالِ مَا أَصْحَابُ الشِّمَالِ ﴿٤١﴾

And those on the **Left**—what of those on the **Left**?

كَيْ لَا يَكُونَ دُولَةً بَيْنَ الْأَغْنِيَاءِ مِنْكُمْ^ج

so that it may not circulate solely **between** the wealthy among you.

لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا وَمَا تَحْتَ الثَّرَى^٦

To Him belongs everything in the heavens and the earth, and everything **between** them, and everything beneath the soil.

يَخْرُجُ مِنْ بَيْنِ الصُّلْبِ وَالتَّرَائِبِ^٧

Issuing from **between** the backbone and the breastbones.

مُصَدِّقًا لِمَا بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ وَهُدًى وَبُشْرَى لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ^{٩٧}

confirming what **preceded**⁴ it, and guidance and good news for the believers.”

يَعْلَمُ مَا بَيْنَ أَيْدِيهِمْ وَمَا خَلْفَهُمْ^ط

He knows what is **in front of** them and what is behind them;

يَعْلَمُ مَا بَيْنَ أَيْدِيهِمْ وَمَا خَلْفَهُمْ^ط

He knows what is in front of them and what is **behind** them;

فَالْيَوْمَ نُنَجِّيكَ بِبَدَنِكَ لِتَكُونَ لِمَنْ خَلْفَكَ آيَةً^ج

Today We will preserve your body, so that you become a sign for those **after** you.

⁴ When بَيْنَ يَدَي is used in this context, it refers to the books already revealed; thus, it makes sense to be translated as the books that preceded.

وَإِذَا سَأَلْتُمُوهُنَّ مَتَاعًا فَسْأَلُوهُنَّ مِنْ وَرَاءِ حِجَابٍ

And when you ask his wives for something, ask them from **behind** a screen;

فَبَشِّرْنَاهَا بِإِسْحَاقَ وَ مِنْ وَرَاءِ إِسْحَاقَ يَعْقُوبَ ﴿٧١﴾

And We gave her good news of Isaac; and **after** Isaac, Jacob.

فَمَنْ أَبْتَغَى وَرَاءَ ذَلِكَ فَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْعَادُونَ ﴿٧٢﴾

But whoever seeks anything **beyond** that—these are the transgressors.

Though the word حَوْلَ is majorly used as a preposition with the meaning of ‘around’, it could also be used as a noun with the meaning of ‘year’. This meaning stems from the fact that a year goes around in circle starting from where it ended. This meaning is, however, much less frequent than its use as a preposition in the Quran.

وَتَرَى الْمَلَائِكَةَ حَافِّينَ مِنْ حَوْلِ الْعَرْشِ يُسَبِّحُونَ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّهِمْ

And you will see the angels hovering **around** the Throne, glorifying their Lord with praise.

وَلِتُنذِرَ أُمَّ الْقُرَى وَمَنْ حَوْلَهَا

that you may warn the Central City and whoever is **around** it,

وَصِيَّةً لَأَزْوَاجِهِمْ مَّتَاعًا إِلَى الْحَوْلِ غَيْرَ إِخْرَاجٍ

a will shall provide their wives with support for a **year**, provided they do not leave.

Wherever

حَيْثُ

وَأَقْتُلُوهُمْ حَيْثُ ثَقِفْتُمُوهُمْ وَأَخْرِجُوهُمْ مِّنْ حَيْثُ أَخْرَجُوكُمْ^ج

And kill them **wherever** you overtake them, and expel them from **where** they had expelled you.

وَحَيْثُ مَا كُنْتُمْ فَوَلُّواْ وُجُوهَكُمْ شَطْرَهُ^ظ

And **wherever** you may be, turn your faces towards it.

Wherever

أَيْنَمَا

أَيْنَمَا تَكُونُوا يُدْرِكُكُمُ الْمَوْتُ وَلَوْ كُنْتُمْ فِي بُرُوجٍ مُّشِيدَةٍ^ظ

Wherever you may be, death will catch up with you, even if you were in fortified towers.

فَأَيْنَمَا تُوَلُّواْ فَثَمَّ وَجْهُ اللَّهِ^ج

Whichever way you turn, there is God's presence.

List FIVE

Prepositions (PART II)

English	Arabic
With/ in/ from	بِـ
About/ away from	عَنْ
In/ during	فِي
As/ like	كَـ
For (belongs to)	لـ
from	مِنْ
(to)wards	إِلَى
Until	حَتَّى
On	عَلَى
With	مَعَ
And/ by(oath)	وَ

List 5-7 – Discussion

The prepositions that belong with list 5-7 are probably the most problematic ones when it comes to translating them in English. A great number of these prepositions are part of a phrasal verb⁵. The Arabic phrasal verbs will, in some cases, use prepositions that do not correspond to their English counterparts e.g. The preposition عَنْ means ‘about’. However, if used as part of a phrasal verb يُخَفِّفُ عَنْهُمْ, it would be translated into ‘lighten for’ not ‘lighten about’. This happens because we translate the meaning rather than word-for-form. So, approach these phrasal verbs with caution. They will be explained in greater detail in Step 6 of this course *in shaa Allah*.

With/ in/ from

بِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

In the name of God, the Gracious, the Merciful.

الَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ

Those who believe in the unseen,

وَالَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِمَا أُنْزِلَ إِلَيْكَ

And those who believe in what was revealed to you,

About

عَنْ

وَلَا تُسْأَلُ عَنْ أَصْحَابِ الْجَحِيمِ

You will not be questioned about the inmates of Hell.

وَإِذَا سَأَلَكَ عِبَادِي عَنِّي فَإِنِّي قَرِيبٌ

And when My servants ask you about Me, I Am near;

⁵ A phrasal verb is a verb that consists of more than one word e.g. ‘look at’, ‘search for’ ..etc. This combination will usually give a different meaning than when the verb is used separately. Compare ‘look after’ vs. ‘look’.

In/ during

فِي

وَقَاتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ الَّذِينَ يُقَاتِلُونَكُمْ

And fight **in** the cause of God those who fight you,

فَمَنْ لَمْ يَجِدْ فَصِيَامُ ثَلَاثَةِ أَيَّامٍ فِي الْحَجِّ

But if he lacks the means, then fasting for three days **during** the Hajj

As/ like

كَ

كَذَلِكَ⁶ جَزَاءُ الْكَافِرِينَ ﴿١٩١﴾

Such is the retribution of the disbelievers.

وَإِنَّ يَوْمًا عِنْدَ رَبِّكَ كَأَلْفِ سَنَةٍ مِّمَّا تَعُدُّونَ ﴿٤٧﴾

A day with your Lord is **like** a thousand years of your count.

For (belongs to)

لِ

لِلْفُقَرَاءِ الَّذِينَ أُحْصِرُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ

It is **for** the poor; those who are restrained in the way of God,

ذَلِكَ الْكِتَابُ لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ ﴿٢﴾

This is the Book in which there is no doubt, a guide **for** the righteous.

⁶ The combination كَذَلِكَ (which is ذَلِك + كَ) is such a common combination in the Quran which means: 'such is'

from

مِنْ

وَأِنْ تُصِيبَهُمْ حَسَنَةٌ يَقُولُوا هَذِهِ مِنْ عِنْدِ اللَّهِ ^ط

When a good fortune comes their way, they say, "This is **from** God."

وَإِذْ نَجَّيْنَاكُمْ مِنْ آلِ فِرْعَوْنَ

And recall that We delivered you **from** the people of Pharaoh.

(to)wards

إِلَى

وَيَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ يُرَدُّونَ إِلَىٰ أَشَدِّ الْعَذَابِ ^ط

And on the Day of Resurrection, they will be assigned **to** the most severe torment.

يَهْدِي مَنْ يَشَاءُ إِلَىٰ صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ ﴿١٤٢﴾

He guides whom He wills **to** a straight path.

Until

حَتَّىٰ

وَلَا تَحْلِقُوا رُءُوسَكُمْ حَتَّىٰ يَبْلُغَ الْهَدْيُ مَحَلَّهُٗ

And do not shave your heads **until** the offering has reached its destination.

لَنْ تَنَالُوا الْبِرَّ حَتَّىٰ تُنْفِقُوا مِمَّا تُحِبُّونَ ^ج

You will not attain virtuous conduct **until** you give of what you cherish.

On

عَلَى

لِلَّهِ عَلَى النَّاسِ حِجُّ الْبَيْتِ مَنِ اسْتَطَاعَ إِلَيْهِ سَبِيلًا

Pilgrimage to the House is a duty to God **for** all who can make the journey.

وَاللَّهُ شَهِيدٌ عَلَىٰ مَا تَعْمَلُونَ ﴿٩٨﴾

when God is a witness **on** what you do?"

With/ among

مَعَ

رَبَّنَا فَاعْفُرْ لَنَا ذُنُوبَنَا وَكَفِّرْ عَنَّا سَيِّئَاتِنَا وَتَوَفَّنَا مَعَ الْأَبْرَارِ

Our Lord! Forgive us our sins, and remit our misdeeds, and make us die **among** the virtuous

رَبَّنَا ءَامِنَّا فَاكْتُبْنَا مَعَ الشَّاهِدِينَ ﴿٨٣﴾

therefore, record us **among** the witnesses of the truth."

And/ by(oath)

وَ

The word و is one of the most frequently used words in the Quran. You will see it used, in the Quranic script, without a 'space' between it and the word that comes after it. So don't let that confuse you, or make you think that it is part of the word. See the following examples

وَالَّتَيْنِ وَالزَّيْتُونَ ﴿١﴾ وَطُورِ سِينِينَ ﴿٢﴾

By oath of the fig and of the olive, (1) **And by** oath of Mount Sinai,

إِلَّا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ

Except those who accepted faith **and** did good deeds –

List SIX

Connectors

English	Arabic
Verily/ truly	إِنَّ
That (+nouns)	أَنَّ
If	إِنْ (لَيْنَ)
to (in order to)/ That (+verbs)	أَنْ
As if	كَأَنَّ
But	لَكِنَّ
When	لَمَّا
If	لَوْ
But for/ why not	لَوْلَا
Before	(مِنْ) قَبْلَ
After	(مِنْ) بَعْدَ
When (for past)	إِذْ
When (for present/future)	إِذَا
Then	ثُمَّ
Then (directly after)/ thereupon	فَ

List 6-7 – Discussion

Verily/ truly

إِنَّ

إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ ﴿١٠﴾

Verily Allah is Able to do all things.

إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَسْتَحْيِي أَنْ يَضْرِبَ مَثَلًا مَّا بَعُوضَةً فَمَا فَوْقَهَا ﴿٣﴾

Verily, Allah is not ashamed to set forth a parable even of a mosquito or so much more when it is bigger than it.

That (+nouns)

أَنَّ

The word أَنَّ can only be followed by nouns. It is important to keep an eye on the tashkeel (short vowels) which you see on top of that word because it can make a difference in the meaning.

أَوَلَا يَعْلَمُونَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ يَعْلَمُ مَا يُسِرُّونَ وَمَا يُعْلِنُونَ ﴿٧٧﴾

Do they not know **that** God knows what they conceal and what they reveal?

أَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ ﴿١٠٦﴾

Do you not know **that** God is capable of all things?

If

إِنْ (لَيْنِ)

فَإِنْ ءَامَنُوا بِمِثْلِ مَا ءَامَنُتُمْ بِهِ فَقَدْ أَهْتَدُوا ﴿٧٧﴾

If they believe in the same as you have believed in, then they have been guided.

فَمَنْ يَمْلِكُ مِنَ اللَّهِ شَيْئًا إِنْ أَرَادَ أَنْ يُهْلِكَ الْمَسِيحَ

“Who can prevent God, **if** He willed, from annihilating the Christ son of Mary,

لَيْنِ بَسَطْتَ إِلَى يَدِكَ لِتَقْتُلَنِي مَا أَنَا بِبَاسِطٍ يَدِيَ إِلَيْكَ لِأَقْتُلَكَ ﴿٧٧﴾

“**If** you extend your hand to kill me, I will not extend my hand to kill you;

to (~~in order to~~)/
That (+verbs)

أَنَّ

قَالَ يَوَيْلَتِي أَعْجَزْتُ أَنْ أَكُونَ مِثْلَ هَذَا الْغُرَابِ

“Woe to me! I was unable **to** be like this raven,

قَالَ سُبْحَانَكَ مَا يَكُونُ لِي أَنْ أَقُولَ مَا لَيْسَ لِي بِحَقِّ

He will say, “Glory be to You! It is not for me **to** say what I have no right to.

As if/ as though

كَأَنَّ

وَلَّى مُسْتَكْبِرًا كَأَنْ لَّمْ يَسْمَعْهَا كَأَنَّ فِي أُذُنَيْهِ وَقْرًا

he turns away in pride, as though he did not hear them, **as though** there is deafness in his ears.

وَإِذْ نَتَقْنَا الْجَبَلَ فَوْقَهُمْ كَأَنَّهُ ظِلَّةٌ وَظَنُّوا

And when We suspended the mountain over them, **as if** it was an umbrella,

But

لَٰكِن

أَلَا إِنَّهُمْ هُمُ الْمُفْسِدُونَ وَلَٰكِن لَّا يَشْعُرُونَ ﴿١٢﴾

In fact, they are the troublemakers, **but** they are not aware.

إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَذُو فَضْلٍ عَلَى النَّاسِ وَلَٰكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَشْكُرُونَ ﴿٢١٣﴾

Verily, God is Gracious towards the people, **but** most people are not appreciative.

When

لَمَّا

فَلَمَّا تَبَيَّنَ لَهُ قَالَ أَعْلَمُ أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ

So **when** it became clear to him, he said, "I know that God has power over all things."

فَقَدْ كَذَّبُوا بِالْحَقِّ لَمَّا جَاءَهُمْ

They denied the truth **when** it has come to them;

If

لَوْ

وَلَوْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ لَذَهَبَ بِسَمْعِهِمْ وَأَبْصَرِهِمْ

If God had willed, He could have taken away their hearing and their sight.

وَلَوْ جَعَلْنَاهُ مَلَكًا لَجَعَلْنَاهُ رَجُلًا

If We had made him an angel, We would have made him a man,

But for/ why not

لَوْلَا

فَلَوْلَا فَضْلُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ وَرَحْمَتُهُ لَكُنْتُمْ مِنَ الْخَاسِرِينَ

Were it not for God's grace and mercy towards you, you would have been among the losers.

وَلَوْلَا دَفْعُ اللَّهِ النَّاسَ بَعْضَهُم بِبَعْضٍ لَفَسَدَتِ الْأَرْضُ

But for God restraining the people, some by means of others, the earth would have gone to ruin.

Before

(مِنْ) قَبْلَ

أَمْ تُرِيدُونَ أَنْ تَسْأَلُوا رَسُولَكُمْ كَمَا سُئِلَ مُوسَى مِنْ قَبْلُ^{قُلْ}

Or do you want to question your Messenger as Moses was questioned **before**?

وَسَبِّحْ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّكَ قَبْلَ طُلُوعِ الشَّمْسِ وَقَبْلَ غُرُوبِهَا^{صَلِّ}

and celebrate the praises of your Lord before the rising of the sun, and **before** its setting.

After

(مِنْ) بَعْدَ

ثُمَّ اتَّخَذْتُمُ الْعِجْلَ مِنْ بَعْدِهِ^{٥١} وَأَنْتُمْ ظَالِمُونَ

Then you took to worshipping the calf **after** him, and you turned wicked.

وَلَيْنِ اتَّبَعْتَ أَهْوَاءَهُمْ بَعْدَ الَّذِي جَاءَكَ مِنَ الْعِلْمِ

Should you follow their desires, **after** the knowledge that has come to you,

When (for past)

إِذْ

وَإِذْ وَعَدْنَا مُوسَى أَرْبَعِينَ لَيْلَةً ثُمَّ اتَّخَذْتُمُ الْعِجْلَ مِنْ بَعْدِهِ^{٥١}

And recall **when** We appointed for Moses forty nights. Then you took to worshipping the calf after him,

وَإِذْ جَعَلْنَا الْبَيْتَ مَثَابَةً لِّلنَّاسِ وَأَمْنًا

And **when** We made the House a focal point for the people,

When (for present/future)

إِذَا

الَّذِينَ إِذَا أَصَابَتْهُمْ مُصِيبَةٌ قَالُوا إِنَّا لِلَّهِ وَإِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ

Those who, **when** a calamity afflicts them, say, “To God we belong, and to Him we will return.”

وَإِذَا سَأَلَكَ عِبَادِي عَنِّي فَإِنِّي قَرِيبٌ

And **when** My servants ask you about Me, I Am near;

Then

ثُمَّ

وَإِذْ وَعَدْنَا مُوسَىٰ أَرْبَعِينَ لَيْلَةً ثُمَّ اتَّخَذْتُمُ الْعِجْلَ مِنْ بَعْدِهِ

And recall when We appointed for Moses forty nights. **Then** you took to worshipping the calf after him,

فَأَمَاتَهُ اللَّهُ مِائَةَ عَامٍ ثُمَّ بَعَثَهُ

Thereupon God caused him to die for a hundred years, and **then** resurrected him.

Then (directly after)/
thereupon

فَ

قَالَ أَنَّى يُحْيِي هَٰذَا اللَّهُ بَعْدَ مَوْتِهَا فَأَمَاتَهُ اللَّهُ

He said, “How can God revive this after its demise?” **Thereupon** God caused him to die for a hundred years, and then resurrected him.

قَالَ فَخُذْ أَرْبَعَةً مِّنَ الطَّيْرِ

He said, “**Then** take four birds,

List SEVEN

Miscellaneous

English	Arabic
Of (belonging to)	ذُو • ذَا • ذِي • ذَات
Of (belonging to)	أُولُوا • أُولى
Family/ People of	أَهْل
Family/ people of	عَالِ
Lo!/ Will .. not ?	أَلَا
What a good ... !	نِعَمَ
What a foul/ bad ..!	بِئْسَ
Like (Example)	مِثْل (مَثَل)
Or	أَوْ
Or ?	أَمْ
Some/ part (of)	بَعْض
Every/ each	كُلُّ
Perhaps/ may	لَعَلَّ
Possibly/ may	عَسَى
O!	يَا (أَيُّهَا)
At/ with/ from	عِنْد • لَدَى • لَدُن

List 7-7 – Discussion

Of (belonging to)

ذُو • ذَا • ذِي • ذَات

These four words are essentially the exact same word. The only difference between them is their position in the sentence. Some words in Arabic can slightly change depending on their function in the sentence. That is why all these words mean the same thing, but they change their ending, depending on their position in the sentence.

وَاللَّهُ يَخْتَصُّ بِرَحْمَتِهِ مَن يَشَاءُ وَاللَّهُ ذُو الْفَضْلِ الْعَظِيمِ ﴿١٠٥﴾

But God chooses for His mercy whomever He wills. God is Possessor **of** Sublime Grace.

وَعَاتِ ذَا الْقُرْبَىٰ حَقَّهُ وَالْمِسْكِينَ وَابْنَ السَّبِيلِ

And give those **of** kinship his rights, and the poor, and the wayfarer,

إِذَا لَبَّتْغُوا إِلَىٰ ذِي الْعَرْشِ سَبِيلًا ﴿٤٢﴾

they would have sought a way to the Lord of the Throne.

وَعَاوَيْنَهُمَا إِلَىٰ رُبُوعٍ ذَاتِ قَرَارٍ وَمَعِينٍ ﴿٥٠﴾

and We sheltered them on high ground **with** security and flowing springs.

Of (belonging to)

أُولُوا • أُولى

Just like the previous entry, these two words are also identical but they have different endings because of their function in the sentence.

وَلَا يَأْتَلِ أُولُوا الْفَضْلِ مِنْكُمْ وَالسَّعَةِ أَن يُؤْتُوا

Those **of** you who have affluence and means should not refuse to give

أَن يُؤْتُوا أُولى الْقُرْبَىٰ وَالْمَسْكِينَ وَالْمُهَاجِرِينَ

to give to **the relatives**, and the needy, and the emigrants for the sake of God.

مَا يَوَدُّ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا مِنْ أَهْلِ الْكِتَابِ وَلَا الْمُشْرِكِينَ

It is never the wish of the disbelievers from among the **People** of the Book, nor of the polytheists,

وَإِنْ خِفْتُمْ شِقَاقَ بَيْنِهِمَا فَأَبْعَثُوا حَكَمًا مِّنْ أَهْلِهِ وَحَكَمًا مِّنْ أَهْلِهَا

If you fear a breach between the two, appoint an arbiter from his **family** and an arbiter from her **family**.

وَإِذْ نَجَّيْنَاكُمْ مِّنْ ءَالِ فِرْعَوْنَ يَسُومُونَكُمْ سُوءَ الْعَذَابِ

And recall when We delivered you from the **people** of Pharaoh. They inflicted on you terrible persecution,

وَيُتِمُّ نِعْمَتَهُ عَلَيْكَ وَعَلَىٰ ءَالِ يَعْقُوبَ كَمَا أَتَمَّهَا

and will complete His blessing upon you and upon the **family** of Jacob,

أَلَا بِذِكْرِ اللَّهِ تَطْمَئِنُّ الْقُلُوبُ ﴿٢٨﴾

Lo! in the remembrance of Allah hearts do find rest.

أَيُّمَسِّكُهُو عَلَىٰ هُونٍ أَمْ يَدُسُّهُو فِي التُّرَابِ ۖ أَلَا سَاءَ مَا يَحْكُمُونَ ﴿٥٩﴾

shall he keep it with ignominy or bury it in the dust! **Lo!** vile is that which they judge!

أَلَا تُحِبُّونَ أَنْ يَغْفِرَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ

Do you **not** love for God to pardon you?

What a good ... !

نِعَمَ

إِنَّا وَجَدْنَاهُ صَابِرًا نِّعَمَ الْعَبْدُ إِنَّهُ أَوَّابٌ ﴿٤٤﴾

We found him patient. **What an excellent** servant! He was obedient.

وَلَقَدْ نَادَيْنَا نُوحَ فَلَنِعْمَ الْمُجِيبُونَ ﴿٧٥﴾

And Noah called out to Us, and We **are the Best** of responders.

What a foul/ bad ..!

بِئْسَ

ثُمَّ أَضْطَرُّهُوَ إِلَىٰ عَذَابِ النَّارِ وَبِئْسَ الْمَصِيرُ ﴿١٣٦﴾

then I will consign him to the punishment of the Fire; **how miserable** the destiny!"

فَحَسْبُهُ وَجَهَنَّمُ وَلَبِئْسَ الْمِهَادُ ﴿٢٠٦﴾

Hell is enough for him—a **dreadful** abode.

Like (Example)

مِثْلُ (مَثَل)

وَلَهُنَّ مِثْلُ الَّذِي عَلَيْهِنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ

And women have rights **similar to** their obligations, according to what is fair.

مَثَلُهُمْ كَمِثْلِ الَّذِي اسْتَوْقَدَ نَارًا فَلَمَّا أَضَاءَتْ مَا حَوْلَهُ

Their **likeness** is **like** that of a person who kindled a fire; when it illuminated all around him,

Or

أَوْ

أَوْ كَصَيِّبٍ مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ فِيهِ ظُلُمَاتٌ وَرَعْدٌ وَبَرْقٌ

Or like a cloudburst from the sky, in which is darkness, and thunder, and lightning.

ثُمَّ قَسَتْ قُلُوبُكُمْ مِّنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ فَهِيَ كَالْحِجَارَةِ أَوْ أَشَدُّ قَسْوَةً

Then after that your hearts hardened. They were as rocks, or even harder.

Or ?

أَمْ

أَمْ تَقُولُونَ عَلَى اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٨٠﴾

or are you saying about God what you do not know?"

أَمْ تُرِيدُونَ أَنْ تَسْأَلُوا رَسُولَكُمْ كَمَا سُئِلَ مُوسَىٰ مِنْ قَبْلُ

Or do you want to question your Messenger as Moses was questioned before?

Some/ part (of)

بَعْضُ

فَقُلْنَا اضْرِبُوهُ بِبَعْضِهَا ۚ كَذَلِكَ يُحْيِي اللَّهُ الْمَوْتَىٰ

We said, "Strike him with part of it.

قَالَ لَبِثْتُ يَوْمًا أَوْ بَعْضَ يَوْمٍ

He said, "I have tarried for a day, or part of a day."

Every/ each/ all

كُلِّ

قَالَ أَعْلَمُ أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ ﴿٢٥٩﴾

he said, "I know that God has power over **all** things."

ثُمَّ أَجْعَلْ عَلَى كُلِّ جَبَلٍ مِّنْهُنَّ جُزْءًا

then place a part on **each** hill,

Perhaps/ may

لَعَلَّ

وَمَا يُدْرِيكَ لَعَلَّ السَّاعَةَ تَكُونُ قَرِيبًا

But what do you know? **Perhaps** the hour is near."

وَأَطِيعُوا اللَّهَ وَالرَّسُولَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ

And obey God and the Messenger, that you **may** obtain mercy.

Possibly/ may

عَسَى

وَعَسَىٰ أَنْ تَكْرَهُوا شَيْئًا وَهُوَ خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ

But it **may** be that you dislike something while it is good for you,

وَعَسَىٰ أَنْ تُحِبُّوا شَيْئًا وَهُوَ شَرٌّ لَّكُمْ

and it **may** be that you like something while it is bad for you.

O!

يَا (يا)

يَقُومُ إِنَّكُمْ ظَلَمْتُمْ أَنْفُسَكُمْ بِاتِّخَاذِكُمُ الْعِجْلَ

“O my people, you have done wrong to yourselves by worshipping the calf.

وَإِذْ قُلْتُمْ يَمُوسَىٰ لَنْ نُؤْمِنَ لَكَ حَتَّىٰ نَرَىٰ اللَّهَ جَهْرَةً

“O Moses, we will not believe in you unless we see God plainly.”

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا لَا تَقُولُوا رَاعِنَا

O you who believe! Do not say ambiguous words,

At/ with/ from

عِنْدَ • لَدَى • لَدُنْ

هُمْ دَرَجَاتٍ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ

They have different ranks **with** God,

إِذِ الْقُلُوبُ لَدَى الْحَنَاجِرِ كَظْمِينَ

when the hearts are **at** the throats, choking them.

وَإِذَا لَاتَيْنَهُمْ مِّن لَّدُنَّا أَجْرًا عَظِيمًا

And We would have given them **from** Our presence a rich compensation.

Addendum

Dealing with ما in the Noble Quran

Types of ما

As we have previously indicated, the Arabic word ما is quite a flexible word because of the different meanings it can be translated to. In order to make it easier to work with this word, we will try to work with it in two different ways. We should first make a distinction between two major types of ما: Separated and attached.

1) Separated ما

When ما is used separately, it will have one of these three meanings: negation, ‘what’, or as a relative pronoun. These meanings are put in an order according to their likelihood to appear in an aya of the Quran. As you progress more in this course, and specifically in step 6 (Quranic Grammar), you will gain more insight on these three meanings of ما and how you can differentiate between them. Naturally, the context of an aya is the most major element that shows which meaning of ما is being use. Therefore, the more you learn, the easier it becomes to detect which meaning it is.

Not (negation)

مَا

وَمَا يَخْدَعُونَ إِلَّا أَنْفُسَهُمْ

but they deceive **none** but themselves,

وَمَا ظَلَمُونَا وَلَكِنْ كَانُوا أَنْفُسَهُمْ يَظْلِمُونَ

They did **not** wrong Us, but they used to wrong their own souls.

What (question word)

مَا

قَالَ مَا مَنَعَكَ إِلَّا تَسْجُدَ إِذْ أَمَرْتُكَ^ط

He said, “**What** prevented you from bowing down when I have commanded you?”

قَالَ يَهْرُونُ مَا مَنَعَكَ إِذْ رَأَيْتَهُمْ ضَلُّوا

He said, “O Aaron, **what** prevented you, when you saw them going astray.

Which/ that
(Relative pronoun)⁷

مَا

مَثَلُهُمْ كَمَثَلِ الَّذِي اسْتَوْقَدَ نَارًا فَلَمَّا أَضَاءَتْ مَا حَوْلَهُ

Their example is like that of one who kindled a fire; and when it lit up all **that** was around it,

وَنَزَعْنَا مَا فِي صُدُورِهِمْ مِّنْ غِلٍّ

We will remove **whatever** rancor is in their hearts.

⁷ Relative pronouns is a word used to refer to nouns mentioned previously, whether they are people, places, things, animals e.g. This is the book which I read. In this example which refers to the book.

2) Attached ما

When ما is used in combination with other words/ prepositions, we will then call it ‘attached’ ما to indicate that it is not a stand-alone word anymore. When that happens, you will see that there are two outcomes for these combinations: one ending with ا and the other ending with just a fat’ha sign (short vowel).

As for the one ending with ا, ما will *almost* always be used as a relative pronoun with the meaning of ‘which/ that’. When it comes to the one ending with fat’ha, it will *always* be used as a question word.

ATTENTION: it is absolutely imperative that you differentiate between the pronunciation of these two outcomes of each combination, since as you can see in the list below, mispronunciation can lead to a change to the meaning. Here are all the possible combinations with ما that you can find the Noble Quran.

ما (with) بِ + مَا			
With which	بِمَا	With what?	بِمَ
ما (about) عَنْ + مَا			
About which?	عَمَّا	About what?	عَمَ
ما (in) فِي + مَا			
In which	فِيمَا	In what?	فِيمَ
ما (from) مِنْ + مَا			
From which	مِمَّا	From what?	مِمَ

لِ (for)	
To/ For which	لِمَا
For what? Why?	لِمَ

Like what/ that	گَ + مَا (like) گَما
--------------------	-------------------------

	ۛ اِنَّ + مَا (verily)	
Verily is	اِنَّمَا	

	أَنْ + مَا (that)
That	أَنَّمَا

	↘ كَانَّ + مَا (as if)
As if	كَانَّمَا

↙	كُلَّ (every) + مَا
Every time	وَكُلَّمَا
Whenever	

↙ أَيْنَ + مَا (where) ↘

Wherever	أَيْنَمَا	wherever	أَيْنَ مَا
----------	-----------	----------	------------

↙ نِعَمَ + مَا (what good) ↘

What good that	نِعَمَّا
----------------	----------

↙ بِئْسَ + مَا (what bad) ↘

What bad that	بِئْسَمَا
---------------	-----------

↙ فَ + مَا (then) ↘

So ... not	فَمَا
------------	-------

Combined ما - Discussion

= مَا + بِ (with)

With which

بِمَا

إِنَّهُ وَ خَيْرٌ بِمَا تَفْعَلُونَ ﴿٨٨﴾

He is fully Informed **of what** you do.

قَالَ رَبِّ بِمَا أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيَّ فَلَنْ أَكُونَ

He said, "My Lord, **with what** you have favored me, I will not be

With what?

بِمَ

فَبِمَ تُبَشِّرُونَ ﴿٥٤﴾

What good news do you bring?"

فَنَظِرَةٌ بِمَ يَرْجِعُ الْمُرْسَلُونَ ﴿٣٥﴾

and will see **what** the envoys bring back."

= مَا + عَنْ (about)

About
which?

عَمَّا

سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ وَتَعَالَى عَمَّا يُشْرِكُونَ ﴿٦٨﴾

Glory be to God, and exalted be He above the associations **(that)** they make.

وَلَيُسْأَلُنَّ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ عَمَّا كَانُوا يَفْتَرُونَ

And they will be questioned on the Day of Resurrection **concerning what** they used to fabricate.

About what?

عَمَّ

عَمَّ يَتَسَاءَلُونَ ﴿١﴾

What are they asking one another about?

= فِي (in) + مَا =

In which

فِيمَا

لِيَحْكُمَ بَيْنَ النَّاسِ فِيمَا اُخْتَلَفُوا فِيهِ

to judge between people **regarding** their differences.

جَعَلَا لَهُ شُرَكَاءَ فِيمَا ءَاتَاهُمَا

they attribute partners to Him **in what** He has given them.

In what?

فِيمَ

فِيمَ أَنْتَ مِنْ ذِكْرِهَا ﴿٤٣﴾

What are you about, to mention it?

قَالُوا فِيمَ كُنْتُمْ

they will say, "What was the matter with you?"

= مِنْ (from) + مَا =

From which

مِمَّا

وَمِمَّا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ يُنْفِقُونَ ﴿٣﴾

and give **from what** We have provided for them.

فَكُلُوا مِمَّا غَنِمْتُمْ حَلَالًا

So consume **from what** you have gained, legitimate and wholesome;

From what?

مِمَّ

فَلْيَنْظُرِ الْإِنْسَانُ مِمَّ خُلِقَ ﴿٥٠﴾

Let man consider **what** he was created **from**.

لِ + مَا (for)

To/ for
which

لِمَا

جَاءَكُمْ رَسُولٌ مُّصَدِّقٌ لِّمَا مَعَكُمْ

should a messenger come to you verifying **what** you have,

مُصَدِّقًا لِّمَا بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ مِنَ التَّوْرَةِ

“And verifying **what** lies before me of the Torah,

For what?
Why?

لِمَ

قُلْ فَلِمَ تَقْتُلُونَ أَنْبِيَاءَ اللَّهِ

Say, “**Why** did you kill God’s prophets

يَا أَهْلَ الْكِتَابِ لِمَ تُحَاجُّونَ فِي إِبْرَاهِيمَ

O People of the Book! **Why** do you argue about Abraham,

كَ + مَا (like)

Just like

كَمَا

الَّذِينَ ءَاتَيْنَاهُمُ الْكِتَابَ يَعْرِفُونَهُ كَمَا يَعْرِفُونَ أَبْنَاءَهُمْ

Those to whom We have given the Book recognize it **as** they recognize their own children.

وَلَقَدْ جِئْتُمُونَا فُرَادَى كَمَا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ

“You have come to Us individually, **just as** We created you the first time,

(verily) إِنَّ + مَا

Verily is

إِنَّمَا

قُلْ إِنَّمَا الْآيَاتُ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ

Say, “**Verily** miracles are only with God,

أَنْ تَقُولُوا إِنَّمَا أُنْزِلَ الْكِتَابُ عَلَى طَائِفَتَيْنِ مِنْ قَبْلِنَا

Lest you say, “**Verily**, The Scripture was revealed to two parties before us,

(that) أَنَّ + مَا

That

أَنَّمَا

وَأَعْلَمُوا أَنَّمَا أَمْوَالُكُمْ وَأَوْلَادُكُمْ فِتْنَةٌ

And know **that** your possessions and your children are a test,

وَلْيَعْلَمُوا أَنَّمَا هُوَ إِلَهُ وَاحِدٌ

and know **that** He is One God,

كَأَنَّ (as if) + مَا

As if

كَأَنَّمَا

مَا لَهُمْ مِنَ اللَّهِ مِنْ عَاصِمٍ ۖ **كَأَنَّمَا** أُغْشِيَتْ وُجُوهُهُمْ قِطْعًا مِّنَ اللَّيْلِ مُظْلِمًا ۚ

They will have no defense against God—**as if** their faces are covered with dark patches of night.

كَأَنَّمَا يَصْعَدُ فِي السَّمَاءِ ۚ

as though he were climbing up the sky.

كُلَّ (every) + مَا

Every time
Whenever

كُلَّمَا

كُلَّمَا دَخَلَتْ أُمَّةٌ لَّعَنَتْ أُخْتَهَا ۖ

Every time a crowd enters, it will curse its sister-crowd.

وَيَصْنَعُ الْفُلْكَ **وَكُلَّمَا** مَرَّ عَلَيْهِ مَلَأُ مِنْ قَوْمِهِ سَخِرُوا مِنْهُ ۚ

As he was building the ark, **whenever** some of his people passed by him, they ridiculed him.

(where) أَينَ + مَا

Wherever

أَيْنَمَا

مَلْعُونِينَ ^طأَيْنَمَا تُقِفُوا

They are cursed; **wherever** they are found,

فَأَيْنَمَا تُولُوا فَثَمَّ وَجْهُ اللَّهِ ^ج

Whichever way you turn, there is God's presence.

Where (?)

أَيْنَ مَا

وَجَعَلَنِي مُبَارَكًا **أَيْنَ** مَا كُنْتُ

And has made me blessed **wherever** I may be;

وَقِيلَ لَهُمْ **أَيْنَ** مَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْبُدُونَ ﴿٩٢﴾

And it will be said to them, “**Where** are those you used to worship?”

(what good) نِعَمَ + مَا

It's excellent

نِعْمًا

إِنْ تُبْدُوا الصَّدَقَاتِ **فَنِعْمًا** هِيَ ^ط

If you give charity openly, **that is good.**

إِنَّ اللَّهَ **نِعْمًا** يَعِظُكُمْ بِهِ

God's instructions to you **are excellent.**

(what bad) بِئْسَ + مَا

It's bad بِئْسَمَا

قَالَ بِئْسَمَا خَلَفْتُمُونِي مِنْ بَعْدِي^ط

“**What an awful** thing you did in my absence.

بِئْسَمَا اشْتَرَوْا بِهِ أَنْفُسَهُمْ

Miserable is what they sold their souls for—

(then) فَ + مَا

So ... not فَمَا

فَمَا وَهَنُوا لِمَا أَصَابَهُمْ

They did **not** waver for what afflicted them

فَمَا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ عَلَيْهِمْ حَفِيظًا

We did **not** send you as a watcher over them.

So .. what is? فَمَا

قَالَ فَمَا خَطْبُكَ يَسْمِيرُ^{٩٥}

He said, “**So what** do you have to say, O Samaritan?”

فَمَا ظَنُّكُمْ بِرَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ^{٨٧}

So what is your opinion about the Lord of the Worlds?”

As for

أَمَّا

وَأَمَّا عَادٌ فَأُهْلِكُوا بِرِيحٍ صَرْصَرٍ عَاتِيَةٍ^٦

And **as for** Aad; they were annihilated by a furious, roaring wind.

وَأَمَّا الْقَاسِطُونَ فَكَانُوا لِجَهَنَّمَ حَطَبًا^{١٥}

But **as for** the compromisers—they will be firewood for Hell.”

قَالُوا يَمُوسَىٰ إِمَّا أَنْ تُلْقِيَ وَإِمَّا أَنْ نَكُونَ نَحْنُ الْمُلْقِينَ ﴿١١﴾

They said, "O Moses! **Either** you throw, **or** we are the ones to throw."

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